01 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

Critique a decision, not the designer.

This workbook compares two authored Context Card alternatives. Alternative A places an excerpt beside the note; alternative B offers a source link below it. Neither is a built or tested interface.

The review asks how each treatment explains the source relationship, supports recovery and uses space. It does not rank a real team's work or invent reviewer approval.

Review purpose

Separate a principle, an annotation and a recommendation. A recommendation needs a stated reason, and a reason may still depend on an untested assumption.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

Alternatives

A adjacent excerpt; B compact note with a source link.

Decision

Choose what to investigate, not which design has won.

Evidence

No actual reviewer comments or assessment scores collected.

Which decision is this review meant to inform?



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

A / P01 / context traceability

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.

02 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

State the constraints before scoring.

Both alternatives use the same invented note and passage. Assume a narrow reading surface and no live source retrieval. Those are comparison conditions, not measured device or service constraints.

Do not penalize B for an unimplemented link response while treating A's unimplemented behavior as complete. Compare represented information separately from missing functionality.

Comparison boundary

A screen-shaped illustration is not an interactive prototype. Record what the artifact actually represents before judging how it would respond.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

Held constant

Passage, note wording and intended reading task.

Assumed

Narrow surface and no live retrieval in the concept artifacts.

Unknown

Real content length, implementation behavior and user context.

Are both alternatives being judged on the same basis?



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

A / P02 / recovery clarity

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.

03 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

Describe both alternatives without a verdict.

A keeps context visible but lengthens the card. B shortens the initial view but moves context behind a navigation step. These are authored structural descriptions, not observations of actual readers.

An annotation should identify an inspectable feature, such as the placement of the source reference. Avoid calling one design intuitive before someone has interpreted it under a defined task.

Alternative overview

Keep a neutral description separate from the reason a reviewer might prefer it. This allows another reader to challenge the reason without denying the visible structure.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

A

Note and source excerpt share the initial concept view.

B

Note remains compact and a source link follows the text.

Open

Neither treatment establishes comprehension or preference.

Can the description stand without an evaluative adjective?



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

A / P03 / reading economy

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.

04 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

Define a rubric without inventing a score.

The three principles are context traceability, recovery clarity and reading economy. Use an ordinal rubric: 0 means not represented, 1 means partly represented, and 2 means coherently represented in the artifact.

The source matrix has two alternatives by three principles, giving six cells. Every score remains null and unassessed. The levels are not interval measurements, so no average or percentage is supplied.

Principle rubric

A future score needs an artifact version and an inspectable rationale. A score of 2 would describe a review judgment, not proven usability.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

P01

Can the source relationship be traced from the represented artifact?

P02

Does the represented recovery path explain its next step?

P03

Does the initial view retain necessary information without redundancy?

Would two reviewers understand what each level means?



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

B / P01 / context traceability

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.

05 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

Review a flow at its actual level of fidelity.

For A, inspect the note and adjacent excerpt together. For B, identify the link and discuss what the destination would need to preserve. Neither artifact demonstrates a working navigation flow.

A missing destination can be recorded as an unresolved dependency rather than a failed observed task. Keep a speculative issue separate from an actual interaction failure.

Flow review

A static comparison can reveal a missing explanation. It cannot establish completion time, error rate or successful navigation.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

A path

Inspect note and visible excerpt in one represented view.

B path

Inspect note, then identify a proposed source-link destination.

Dependency

Destination content and return behavior are unspecified.

What can this artifact show, and what does it only suggest?



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

B / P02 / recovery clarity

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.

06 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

Anchor an annotation to a visible feature.

Name the alternative, principle and feature before recording an interpretation. For example, B's source link may raise a question about returning to the note. That is an authored concern, not a quoted finding.

Keep the original feature description intact when a recommendation changes. A later reviewer should be able to see why the discussion began rather than only the final proposed fix.

Annotation anatomy

Use a stable annotation ID and artifact version in any real review. Do not attach a fictional reviewer name to make the example look witnessed.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

Locator

Alternative B, source-link placement beneath the note.

Interpretation

Returning to the note may need a visible relationship.

Question

What should remain visible at the proposed destination?

Can someone locate the feature behind the comment?



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

B / P03 / reading economy

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.

07 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

Explore an alternative that addresses a named tension.

A third sketch could pair a short excerpt with a fuller source reference. It may reduce the need to navigate while retaining a longer context route, but it also adds content to the card.

This is a possible response to the tension, not a scored third alternative in the six-cell matrix. Add it to the source model only when the comparison scope is deliberately revised.

Alternative generation

A hybrid is not automatically better. Ask which original uncertainty it addresses and what new ambiguity it introduces.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

Candidate

A short excerpt plus an explicit fuller-source reference.

Potential cost

More initial content and another relationship to explain.

Boundary

The current scored-scope matrix still contains A and B only.

Does the new sketch address the reason for the critique?



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

A / P01 / context traceability

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.

08 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

Preserve disagreement instead of averaging it away.

One reviewer could favor visible context while another could prioritize a compact view. This is a hypothetical disagreement, not an actual meeting record. Neither position becomes evidence by being repeated.

If a real review differs, record each rationale and the criterion involved. Do not manufacture consensus through a mean of ordinal scores or describe silence as agreement.

Disagreement record

A next action may be to test a particular question rather than choose a winner. Unresolved disagreement can be useful if its source is clear.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

Position example

Visible context may support traceability.

Counterpoint example

A compact surface may reduce initial reading burden.

Next question

Which information is needed to explain the note's source?

What would distinguish a difference in values from a missing fact?



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

A / P02 / recovery clarity

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.

09 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

Turn a concern into a bounded revision request.

A revision request should name an artifact feature, the intended explanation and a check. For B, specify that the destination must preserve a visible route back to the note before planning a walkthrough.

Do not promise that adding a return cue resolves all navigation problems. The request describes a change to inspect, not a measured improvement or an assigned delivery commitment.

Revision list

Keep unresolved assumptions alongside proposed changes. Otherwise a cleaner sketch can conceal the question it was meant to answer.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

Change

Describe a note-linked destination and an explicit return cue.

Check

Inspect whether the relationship remains understandable in the sketch.

Owner

No actual implementer, deadline or approval has been assigned.

What evidence would allow this request to be closed?



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

A / P03 / reading economy

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.

10 / DESIGN CRITIQUE

Review the quality of the review itself.

The matrix contains six unassessed cells, not six low scores. The useful output is a clearer set of questions about two alternatives and the criteria used to compare them.

Before sharing, check that annotations distinguish description, interpretation and recommendation. Remove invented quotations, numerical claims and approval language unsupported by real review records.

Critique handoff

A later real assessment should preserve artifact versions and rationales. Completion of this workbook is not an endorsement or a release gate.

PRINCIPLE / FEATURE / REVIEW QUESTION

Matrix

Two alternatives, three principles, six null scores.

Output

Traceable questions and bounded revision suggestions.

Limit

No real review, usability result or stakeholder approval recorded.

Which part of the critique remains an assumption?



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

REVIEW CELL

B / P01 / context traceability

RUBRIC BOUNDARY

0 not represented; 1 partly represented; 2 coherent. All 6 scores null.